

Ph.D. (Management) Course Work

Course Name: Research and Publication Ethics

Credit: 02

Course Objective: The purpose of this course is to enable the students understand the basics of philosophy of science and ethics, research integrity, publication ethics. Hands-on-sessions are designed to identify research misconduct and predatory publications. Indexing and citation databases, open access publications, research metrics (citations, h-index, Impact Factor, etc.) and plagiarism tools will be introduced in this course.

UNIT I

Philosophy and Ethics: Introduction to philosophy: definition, nature and scope, concept, branches; Ethics: definition, moral philosophy, nature of moral judgements and reactions.

UNIT II

Scientific Conduct: Ethics with respect to science and research; Intellectual honesty and research integrity; Scientific misconducts: Falsification, Fabrication, and Plagiarism (FFP); Redundant publications: duplicate and overlapping publications, salami slicing; Selective reporting and misrepresentation of data.

UNIT III

Publication Ethics: Publication ethics: definition, introduction and importance; Best practices / standards setting initiatives and guidelines: COPE, WAME, etc.; Conflicts of interest; Publication misconduct: definition, concept, problems that lead to unethical behaviour and vice versa, types; Violation of publication ethics, authorship and contributor ship; Identification of publication misconduct, complaints and appeals; Predatory publishers and journals.

UNIT IV

Open Access Publishing: Open access publications and initiatives; SHERPA/ RoMEO online resource to check publisher copyright & self-archiving policies; Software tool to identify predatory publications developed by SPPU; Journal finder / journal suggestion tools viz. JANE, Elsevier Journal Finder, Springer Journal Suggester, etc.

UNIT V

Group Discussions: Subject specific ethical issues, FFP, authorship; Conflicts of interest; Complaints and appeals: examples and fraud from India and abroad. Software Tools: Use of plagiarism software like Turnitin, Urkund and other open-source software tools.

UNIT VI

Databases: Indexing databases; Citation databases: Web of Science, Scopus, etc. Research Metrics: Impact Factor of journal as per Journal Citation Report, SNIP, SJR, IPP, Cite Score; Metrics: h-index, g index, i10 index, altmetrics.

Suggested Readings:

1. Bird, A. (2006). Philosophy of Science. Routledge.
2. MacIntyre, Alasdair (1967) A Short History of Ethics. London.
3. P. Chaddah, (2018) Ethics in Competitive Research: Do not get scooped; do not get plagiarized, ISBN:9789387480865
4. National Academy of Sciences, National Academy of Engineering and Institute of Medicine. (2009). On Being a Scientist: A Guide to Responsible Conduct in Research: Third Edition. National Academies Press. Resnik, D. B. (2011). What is ethics in research & why is it important. National Institute of Environmental Health